

Seminar on Context-Sensitivity

Hilary 2009

Readings for Weeks 1 and 2

1 The background conception of propositions

Richard Cartwright. 'Propositions'. In: *Analytical Philosophy*. Ed. by R.J. Butler. 1st. Oxford: Basil Blackwell, 1962, pp. 81–103.

Stephen Schiffer. *The Things We Mean*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2003.

Jeffrey C. King. 'Designating Propositions'. *Philosophical Review* 111 (2002), pp. 341–371.

2 The notion of "the proposition semantically expressed"

There's ever so much you could read about this. Here are a few things I have found helpful in my own thinking about the topic.

H.P. Grice. 'Logic and Conversation'. In: *Syntax and Semantics, Volume 3: Speech Acts*. Ed. by Peter Cole and Jerry Morgan. New York: Academic Press, 1975, pp. 41–58.

David Lewis. 'Languages and Language'. In: *Language, Mind and Knowledge*. Ed. by Keith Gunderson. Vol. 7. Minnesota Studies in the Philosophy of Science. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1975, pp. 3–35.

Scott Soames. *Beyond Rigidity: The Unfinished Semantic Agenda of Naming and Necessity*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2002, chapter 3.

3 Arguments for context-sensitivity and how they might be resisted

We will focus on this topic in more detail in Weeks 5 and 6. Here are a couple of things to look at if you want to get started thinking about it now.

Herman Cappelen and Ernest Lepore. *Insensitive Semantics: A Defense of Semantic Minimalism and Speech Act Pluralism*. Malden, Mass: Blackwell, 2005.

Gerhard Preyer and Georg Peter, eds. *Context-Sensitivity and Semantic Minimalism: New Essays on Semantics and Pragmatics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007.

4 The indexical approach to context-sensitivity

David Kaplan. 'Demonstratives'. In: *Themes from Kaplan*. Ed. by John Perry Joseph Almog and Howard Wettstein. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1989, pp. 481–566.

David Kaplan. 'Afterthoughts'. In: *Themes from Kaplan*. Ed. by John Perry Joseph Almog and Howard Wettstein. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1989, pp. 564–614.

David Lewis. 'Scorekeeping in a Language Game'. *Journal of Philosophical Logic* 8 (1979).

David Lewis. 'Index, Context and Content'. In: *Philosophy and Grammar*. Ed. by Stig Kanger and Sven Öhman. Dordrecht: Kluwer Academic Publishers, 1980.

Robert C. Stalnaker. 'Pragmatics'. *Synthese* 22 (1970).

Robert C. Stalnaker. 'On the Representation of Context'. *Journal of Logic, Language, and Information* 7 (1998).

5 Alternatives to the indexical approach

Kent Bach. 'Conversational Implicature'. *Mind and Language* 9 (1994), pp. 124–162.

Kent Bach. 'Context *Ex Machina*'. In: *Semantics versus Pragmatics*. Ed. by Zoltán Gendler Szabó. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2005, pp. 15–44.

Robyn Carston. *Thoughts and Utterances: The Pragmatics of Explicit Communication*. Oxford: Blackwell, 2002.

François Recanati. *Direct Reference: From Language to Thought*. Oxford: Blackwell, 1993, (especially the first two chapters of Part 2).

François Recanati. *Literal Meaning*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2003.

Scott Soames. 'Drawing the Line Between Meaning and Implicature — and Relating both to Assertion'. *Noûs* 42 (2008), pp. 529–554.

Scott Soames. 'The Gap Between Meaning and Assertion'. In: *Philosophical Papers Vol. 1*. Princeton: Princeton University Press, 2008.

Jason Stanley. *Language in Context*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007. (Contains extensive criticisms of many of the other authors listed above. The introduction provides a helpful overview of the debate.)